SIG Handbook

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1 Foreword

This document outlines the baseline requirement for all SIGs. SIGs fundamentally should be free to manage themselves, however it is the beleif of CompSoc that there are some things which are non-negotiable to keep SIGs functioning and to keep everyone safe.

This is not a document for SIGs to edit. There are provisions for this to be modified through a formal process, however as these conditions are fundamental in maintaining the safety of everyone involved this document is intended to stay mostly static.

Thank you to all involved in keeping our SIGs best-in-class, you make CompSoc great.

Thank you to Marton, the author of the SIG handbook before the 2026 rewrite, who large portions of this document have been mercilessly copied from.

CompSoc <3 you, from Skye, Emily, and all editors who may follow (add your names).

1.1 Formalisation of Terms

1.1.1 "will" and "must" is a requirement, "should" is an ideal situation to be aimed for, "may" is a choice a committee has avaliable to them but not a requirement.

1.1.2 A "hard majority" is a vote in favour by equal or greater than two thirds of total committee, a "soft majority" is greater than half of committee at a meeting. Unless otherwise mentioned, when relating to CompSoc committee specifically, a hard majority is committee only, a soft majority is committee plus SIG representitive members present at a meeting, one vote per SIG.

1.1.3 University in session means any time the uni should typically be running.

1.1.4 Out of session is breaks/holidays, and informally also reading weeks and exam periods. Unless its an emergency, leniency on how fast things can be done will be given during these times. Out-of-session does not include strike days or any other day where

everyone is in Edinburgh and university would normally be teaching classes, unless otherwise stated.

2 Modifying this document

The process for modifying this document is as follows:

2.1 Before a motion is brought forward, adequate steps should be taken to discuss the concept of the motion within the committee that is filing it (be that SIG committee or CompSoc) as well as with SIGs affected or other SIGs in general. This is to avoid re-filing with modifications if the motion is struck down.

2.2 A SIG president or SIG executive or a member of CompSoc committee brings forward a motion to modify this document. This motion must contain a suggested change as well as a motivation for this change.

2.3 This motion will be voted on in a CompSoc committee meeting. The following requirements are sorted in order of priority, and are mirrored in the CompSoc constitution but are here for information. Changes to this section specifically must be done through a constitutional amendment at a GM due to this, although an emergency modification may be made through the following process. The newest modification must be held as priority.

- 2.3.1 All SIGs must be made aware of when and where the meeting to vote will be held, and given a copy of the motion with proposed changes at minimum 72 hours before the meeting. Importantly, the reason for filing and the SIG who put the motion forward should not be communicated. This is to allow SIGs with legitimate concern about another SIGs actions to step forward without SIG committee fearing retribution.
- 2.3.2 This meeting must be held before an upcoming holiday or break unless the committee who put forward the motion agrees to have it after.
- 2.3.3 This meeting must be at maximum three meetings after the motion if brought forward.

SIGs may send either their president or another committee member the president designates as a representitive. Multiple members of a SIG may be present to discuss but final votes are from the president or their representitive.

2.4 Voting must be done in a way to promote anonimity for the ones voting. See the **suggestion section** for suggestions on how to do this. Voting should be done in person so the motion submitter can defend their decision or concerns can be raised. It may also be a good idea to make a discussion thread for a motion before it is voted on, to save time in committee meetings.

2.5 If a motion is passed it is integrated into this document.

2.6 If a motion fails it may be brought back under one of the following conditions:

- 2.6.1 A situation has changed significantly enough to warrant reconsideration
- 2.6.2 A modification to address complaints has been made.
- 2.6.3 Someone has come to harm requiring a motion to be reconsidered even if it failed before.
- 2.6.4 A motion is over 6 months old, or from a previous committee set and the new SIG committees resonably may have a different view on it.
- 2.6.5 Enough SIGs have, in writing, expressed their desire to change their vote on a previous failed motion to tip the scales.

3 Committee

3.1 A committee must have at minimum three members, one of which is designated as the president.

3.2 Committee must uphold the goal of the SIG and of CompSoc.

3.3 Committee must not put anyone in danger, allow harm to come to a member while at a committee activity or event, and uphold the rights of every member, including keeping event inclsivity in mind and preventing hatespeech, antisocial behaviour, and crimes.

3.4 If a Committee becomes aware of a danger to SIG members outside of SIG event times they must make CompSoc aware immediately.

3.5 If harm in any way is to come to a member of a SIG during or relating to a SIG activity event or service CompSoc must be informed immediately. Letting CompSoc know will be viewed in your favour, often something occuring isn't as bad as trying to hide that something happened, so its always best to file.

3.6 A SIG should file a risk assessment if they perceive an event to be large enough or high risk enough for it to be resonable, and must file one if requested by CompSoc committee.

3.7 SIGs may reach out to the CompSoc EDI Representitive for help or guidence on keeping events accessable and safe.

3.8 A committee may defer an internal vote to CompSoc if they are unable to reach a decision, however a limit may be put on this if it is overused.

3.9 If a disagreement about leadership arises, a SIG may request CompSoc Vice President (who may delegate this task to a chosen representitive also on CompSoc committee) to assist in resolving the issue and/or mediate in any discussion.

4 CompSoc committee meetings

4.1 SIGs may attend CompSoc committee meetings and vote in votes.

4.2 SIGs may vote in CompSoc general committee meetings, in which case a SIG posesses one vote regardless of the amount of members present. The SIG must have a representitive present to vote, although an exception may be made if a SIGs representitive has made a sufficient effort to make committee aware they'd like to vote online.

4.3 A SIG representitive is either the president or a SIG committee member the president has designated as their representitive.

5 Activities and Events

5.1 SIGs must run at minimum one activity or special event per month while university is in session to be considered active. In session time for this point specifically does not include strike days. A SIG may choose to be involved in a strike.

5.2 An activity is an often recurring event. These are core to the SIGs running.

5.3 A special event is one which happens yearly, or is in some way larger or requiring more planning than an activity.

5.4 Please see the **suggestion section** for ideas on activities and events.

6 Finance

6.1 SIGs must use the CompSoc bank account unless granted an exemption.

6.2 Exemptions are granted and removed by a soft majority CompSoc committee w/o SIGs vote.

6.3 Any CompSoc committee member may ask to audit a SIG private bank account, at which point the SIG committee must send an electronic bank statement dating back 3 months or more to the requester within 72 hours while University is in session or 1 week while it is out of session. If the bank only provides paper bank statements, an electronic proof of statement request must be sent instead and the actual statement must be handed over once it arrives.

6.4 SIGs must NEVER enter into debt. Committees should also not knowingly put a SIG into a financial or sponsorship position where the next committee is severely disadvantaged.

6.5 SIGs may request funding from CompSoc.

6.6 SIGs must not charge members for any activities or services provided by the SIG.

6.7 SIGs must not charge subscriptions of any kind.

6.8 SIGs may charge for tickets to special events.

6.9 Sponsorship

6.9.1 SIGs may seek their own sponsors. Any funds raised belong to that SIG alone.

6.9.2 Contracts must not extend over a year to a new committee, but may have a renewal mechanism a following committee may use to get that sponsor for another year.

6.9.3 A SIG should seek prior approval and make appropriate notification before contacting, seeking out, or aquiring a sponsor another SIG or CompSoc is already sponsored by. This is to prevent sponsor poaching.

6.9.4 A sponsorship is the only relationship a SIG may have with a company. SIGs must never be owned or operate under another company.

7 Communication and Branding

7.1 SIGs must acknowledge their affiliation with CompSoc as a Special Interest Group on their website and communication channels.

7.2 SIGs may use CompSoc's communication channels to promote their events and activities, subject to restrictions and queuing requirements.

7.3 SIGs may request to bridge the general and announcement channels of their Discord servers to a dedicated channel in the CompSoc Discord server.

7.4 SIGs may request branding and promotion help from the CompSoc Graphic Designer.

8 Code of Conduct

8.1 SIG members who violate the EUSA Society Code of Conduct will be subject to disciplinary action. Please see the **diciplinary action section** for details.

9 SIG Renewal

9.1 SIGs must provide the CompSoc committee with an annual update on their membership, activities, and plans for the upcoming year.

10 SIG Mandates

A new addition to this document is SIG Mandates. This is a mechanism for SIGs to make expansions to the handbook which apply to their own SIG. The following are points on what must should and may be in a mandate. It is not an exclusive list. It is recomended to read the **suggestion section** when making or modifying a mandate.

10.1 A mandate must include:

10.1.1 The mechanism to update the mandate

10.1.2 A resonable mechanism for a vote of no confidence to be cast by members against committee. This is to prevent a bad committee remaining in power if ever one emerge.

10.2 A mandate should include:

10.2.1 A mechanism to vote on contraversial sponsors.

10.3 A mandate may include:

10.3.1 Defined roles and responsabilities for certain members of SIG committees beyond the president.

11 Disciplinary Action

11.1 Against a member

11.2 Against a SIG or its Committee

12 Inactivity

Inactivity is a natural state for a SIG which has reached the end of its life. If a SIG becomes inactive by abandonment, it should be allowed to die, but CompSoc must do its best to preserve documentation in case it is ever to be restarted, and for its historical significance. Following are a few definitions:

13 Suggestions

This segment is for committee's to pass on knowledge about ways of doing things to future generations and does not require a vote to modify. The only requirement is CompSoc committee is made aware of a suggestion you'd like to add. This is so changes can be tracked and to avoid irresponsible additions.

- Use google forms or something like that for voting and make the CompSoc VP make the form so no one else can see responses. I know it sucks but it can't be 100% anonymous as someone needs to make sure the right people voted and no one is counted twice.
- Be wary of trying to run elections in a SIG, you all know who's worked the hardest this year and would be good to leave in charge, and elections kill sigs. like, in under a year. its bad.
- Activities are eg. pub nights, practice sessions, project sessions, weekly meetings, coffee's, etc. but should be somewhat related to the SIGs goals.
- Events are hackathons, CTFs, conferences etc and not everyone has to run one of these ok especially if your sig can't afford it!!